

turned out to be one of the most innovative graphics cards ever. At the same time, they also introduced their ‘Catalyst’ driver suite, which addressed many of the quality, compatibility, and performance concerns raised about previous driver releases.

A decision was taken for core chip technology to be licensed to third-party “Powered by ATi” board manufacturers, adopting nVidia’s business model. All this suddenly put nVidia on the back foot for the first time since the NV1 project.

ATi refreshed the 9700 to the 9800 Pro in 2003, featuring a small and relatively quiet cooling solution. The 9800 went on to become one of the most popular and best-selling enthusiast cards of all time.

In the recent past, ATi has begun shipping the X800 XL PCIe card. Priced at \$100 (Rs 4,400) less than the competing 6800 GT product from nVidia, ATi may be right in believing they have once again found a winning balance of performance, features, process technology, and yields.

As of now, with the release of the GeForce 7 series, nVidia has become the market leader once again. ATi recently released a card to compete against the 7 series with the Radeon X1000 series.

The Xbox 360 will contain a custom ATi graphics chip.

The evolution of the graphics card industry has been a whirlwind after nVidia entered the market, and six-monthly production cycles have now become the norm. Come December, there will be something new from the nVidia stables, and as always, we will keep you posted.

In the next chapter, we talk about where gaming is headed.